



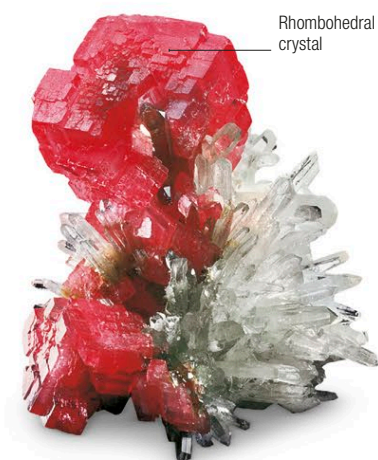
Rhodochrosite

△ Fine-quality, transparent brilliant-cut rhodochrosite

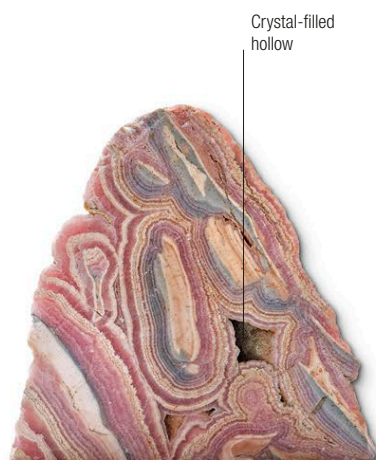
Rhodochrosite's classic colour is rose-pink. It occurs both as transparent crystals and banded stalactitic rock, and is soft and very fragile; faceted clear crystals are rare and sought after. Vibrant, facet-quality, cherry-red crystals are found in Colorado, USA, and at Hotazel in South Africa. Banded "Inca rose" rhodochrosite comes from Argentina: this is the main source of banded material, which is cut *en cabochon*, into beads, and used in carvings. Concentrically banded slices of rhodochrosite stalactites are polished and mounted in silver as pendants.

Specification

Chemical name Manganese carbonate | **Formula** MnCO_3
Colours Rose-pink, cherry red | **Structure** Hexagonal or trigonal
Hardness 3.5–4 | **SG** 3.6 | **RI** 1.6–1.8 | **Lustre** Vitreous to pearly | **Streak** White | **Locations** USA, South Africa, Romania, Gabon, Mexico, Russia, Japan



Rhodochrosite on quartz | Rough | In this magnificent specimen, facet-grade rhombohedral crystals of rhodochrosite rest on a group of quartz crystals.



"Inca rose" | Cut | The distinctive swirls and patterns of this slice of massive rhodochrosite are characteristic of the Argentinian variety called "Inca rose".



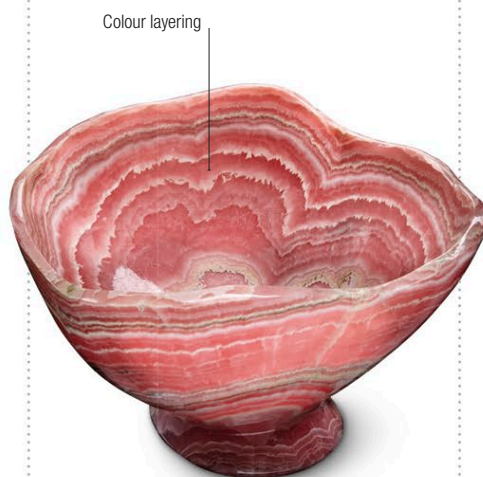
Brilliant oval | Cut | One of the most difficult gems to facet because of its softness, this brilliant oval has been cut by a highly skilled lapidary.



Cabochon | Cut | The swirls and layering typical of massive rhodochrosite are clearly seen in this irregular-shaped rhodochrosite cabochon.



Necklace | Set | Created by Tony Duquette (1914–99), this glorious necklace contains pearl, amber, rose quartz, amethyst, garnet, and a large rhodochrosite.



Rhodochrosite bowl | Carved | The lapidary has shaped this bowl to emphasize the superb natural pattern of the soft and easy to carve rhodochrosite.



Rhodochrosite parrot | Carved | Made by a master lapidary in Idar-Oberstein, Germany, in the late 20th century this parrot has a black agate beak, and stands on a base of quartz.